

Project Format: Short Documentary

Project Title: Africville: A Community Displaced

Introduction:

In the heart of Halifax, Nova Scotia, lies a forgotten chapter of history that speaks volumes about resilience and injustice—a chapter written by the community of Africville. “Africville: A Community Displaced” is envisioned as more than just a short documentary; I hope it will serve as a window into a world where a vibrant community, built on hope and perseverance, was systematically erased from the landscape. Founded by Black settlers escaping persecution, Africville thrived despite relentless neglect and adversity. But in the 1960s, urban renewal policies and systemic racism led to its destruction, severing generations of familial and cultural ties. By exploring Africville’s rich history and the injustices it faced, the project aims to shed light on untold stories and inspire a deeper understanding among Nova Scotians and Canadians alike. Through this exploration, I hope to reveal not only the enduring legacy of Africville but also the broader implications of systemic racism and urban renewal policies.

Project Goals:

Impact: This short documentary would foster civic engagement through educating individuals in Nova Scotia and beyond about the significance of Africville in African Nova Scotia History as well as the negative effects of its demobilization.

This project intends to create a long-term form of education about Africville, unveiling the history of a community which contributed heavily to Nova Scotia as we see it now. Hopefully, this short film will be shown in public libraries throughout the city. My efforts would include presenting the short film to middle school and high school students around Nova Scotia as a short presentation.

Due to the lack of focus on educating young students about Africville through creative lenses such as a short film, it is often a topic that goes unheard of by this demographic especially. With a short film, educational value could be given to young students in attention-provoking ways.

Methods and Strategies:

Target Audience: The target audience for this short film would be students in middle and high school. This short film will have a serious tone to get across an important message which an elementary student may fail to understand. Still, it is important to not just repeat information to people who are already well educated in the subject, so it will be targeted to students who already have a basic understanding of related subjects such as Africville's History. It has been found that students learn effectively when they can connect related subjects, so

educating grade levels with related topics in their curriculum could enhance the actual understanding of the short film.

Engagement: Student engagement with the film is one of the main objectives, which can be enhanced through creating a film that has a variation of information of the past and current status of Africville.

Feasibility: To ensure this project is feasible with the grant amount, I aim to make it about 10 minutes long. To better divide the film, there will be three acts, including interviewing and storytelling.

Sharing: I will use social media platforms such as Instagram to share the documentary, as well as get others to share the short film on their social; media platforms. I hope to also create a website with descriptions of the topics and specific references in the video, this way it can be used educationally for students to use to find research. This website would be included with the presentation given to students and could be used for interactive activities by teachers through website scavenger hunts and research projects. With great experience in social media marketing, I have all the skills to create the website platform for free, and make digital promotions myself.

Activities and Tasks:

Overview: The film will be divided into 3 Acts, consisting of interviews and storytelling. The 3 acts will focus on the history of Africville and its demolition, and why the events made a significant impact. In Addition to the main focus on historical significance, the film will also delve into the cultural, educational and economic status of the community before and after the demolition.

Act 1:Storytelling

Focus:

In the heart of Halifax, Nova Scotia, Africville stood as a beacon of resilience and community for over a century. Founded in the early 1800s by Black settlers, many of whom were former slaves and loyalists fleeing persecution in the United States, Africville thrived as a vibrant, close-knit community. Act 1 focuses on telling the history of Africville from its development in 1836 up to its demolition in 1962. Black settlers arrived in Nova Scotia as they had been formerly enslaved and promised freedom and land, which was far from the reality of what history unveils. Due to racism, these settlers were forced to inhospitable land where they developed vibrant communities such as Africville. This act vividly portrays Africville as a thriving community, highlighting the establishment of the Seaview African United Baptist Church, local businesses, and the tight-knit homes that formed the heart of the community. However, its residents faced persistent neglect from city authorities, enduring decades without essential services like running water and proper sewage systems. Despite these challenges, Africville remained a symbol of strength and cultural pride. Tragically, in the 1960s, the city of Halifax deemed Africville a blight on its landscape and forcibly demolished the community. This decision, rooted in

systemic racism and urban renewal policies of the time, devastated Africville's residents, severing generations of familial and community ties.

This Act will have a variation of B-roll film coordinated with the subjects covered, such as showing the Africville Museum and the historic community in its current state. To gather this film, the videographer will get numerous videos and photos of the area currently, and I will collect older videos of the vibrant community.

Act 2: Interview with a Researcher

Delving deeper into Africville's complex history and its demolition, Act 2 will feature a researcher knowledgeable on the subject of Africville (whom I have identified), will further explain the socioeconomic factors which caused the Africville relocation. They will present research which emphasizes how systemic neglect and discriminatory practices contributed to the deterioration of Africville, culminating in its forced demolition. This interview will serve as a critical lens through which we can understand the more specific implications of decisions made by the City of Halifax Committee that impacted Africville socially, economically, and health-wise.

Act 3: Interviews with Africville Residents and Descendants

- In Act 3, we will amplify the voices of Africville's survivors, descendants, and community members whose lives were forever altered by their experiences in this historic neighborhood. Through interviews, this act will include firsthand accounts of life in Africville through stories of joy, hardship, and solidarity among adversity. These personal narratives highlight the cultural and emotional ties that bound Africville's residents together, despite the harsh conditions they faced. Further, we will explore through interviews how the demolition of Africville reverberates through generations, impacting descendants who continue to advocate for justice. Their stories will help reflect resilience, community activism, and a collective determination to preserve Africville's memory and fight against systemic racism and social injustice.
- Alongside the videographer who will capture the few minutes of interviewing for Acts 2 and 3, I will be interviewing the researcher and other interviewees, asking questions about what is written in history as well as personal experiences of Africville and its legacy.

Implementation Plan:

Objective: Create a 10-minute documentary that explores the history, impact, and legacy of Africville, focusing on its demolition and the ongoing efforts to preserve its memory and fight against systemic racism.

Phase 1: Research

- Project Planning and Research: To start the developing research, I will define the documentary's goals, focusing on telling Africville's story through historical context, expert insights, and personal stories. To

many, Africville is not a known subject, as it is not in school curriculums despite it being a significant part of history for African Nova Scotians and the province as a whole.

- This project will draw on various disciplines like history, sociology, and media production to create a strong and engaging narrative that will give viewers a deep understanding of the events of Africville. I'll dive deep into Africville's history, learning about its beginnings, challenges, and eventual demolition to provide thought provoking information for the short film, which will include visuals, timelines and aspects of Africville history that often go unheard.

Digitization and Compliance Considerations: To make the short film have engagement and accessibility, I'll explore ways to use digital tools to create a website that gives context on the events in Africville along with the short film. To increase educational value, there will be a classroom-friendly interactive quiz feature for students to show their understanding of this part in history. Additionally, I will consider legal restrictions or copyrights when using images and videos for the website.

Phase 2: Production

Filming Act 1: I'll begin production by filming the introduction and historical context of Africville. This will include capturing shots of the area, archival footage, and images that tell Africville's story. I'll record narration to provide context and set the stage for the rest of the documentary. This segment will inform viewers about Africville's significance and its place in Canadian history.

Filming Act 2: Interview with a Researcher: For the second act, I'll interview an expert who can shed light on the socioeconomic factors that led to Africville's demolition. This interview will give viewers a deeper understanding of the systemic neglect and discriminatory practices that contributed to Africville's forced destruction. I'll make sure the expert knows the topics we want to cover and encourage them to share detailed insights and analysis.

Filming Act 3: For this act, I'll interview Africville residents, descendants, and community members. Their personal stories will highlight the cultural and emotional bonds that united Africville's residents and how its demolition continues to affect generations. I'll encourage interviewees to share stories of joy, hardship, and solidarity, as well as their ongoing efforts to preserve Africville's memory and fight for justice.

Phase 3: Post-Production

Editing and Assembly: With all the footage captured, I'll move on to editing. I'll carefully review and select the best clips from each interview and segment, piecing them together to form a cohesive and engaging narrative. I'll add B-roll footage, archival materials, and any necessary graphics or subtitles to support the storytelling and enhance the documentary's visual appeal.

Feedback and Revisions: Once I have a rough cut, I'll share it with key partners, including community members, interviewees, and advisors, to gather feedback. Their input will be invaluable in ensuring the documentary accurately reflects Africville's story and resonates with the audience. By asking community members, I can get firsthand feedback on how impactful the short film will be to the public. Based on their feedback, I'll make any necessary revisions to improve the narrative, pacing, and overall impact of the film.

Finalization and Sound Design: With the documentary's structure and content finalized, I'll focus on sound design and final touches. This includes mixing audio levels, adding background music where appropriate, and ensuring the overall sound quality is professional and clear. I'll also finalize any graphics, titles, and credits to complete the film.

Phase 4: Distribution and Promotion

Promotion and Social Media Campaign: To get the word out about the documentary, I'll develop a promotional strategy that includes a social media campaign, press releases, and promotional materials like trailers and posters. With my personal experience using video editing software for other projects, I will be able to create a short trailer which will be posted on social media platforms. I'll use platforms such as Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn to reach a wide audience and generate interest in the film. Collaborating with community organizations will help spread the message and reach diverse audiences. This social media strategy will be key to mobilizing civic knowledge and engagement.

Screenings and Community Engagement: I'll organize screenings by reaching out to organizations such as Imhotep Legacy Academy and Delmore Buddy Daye Learning Institute to spread awareness about Africville to young students. Partnering with these educational institutions and community groups will help expand the reach and impact of the documentary.

Impact Assessment and Reporting

After the documentary's release, I'll conduct an impact assessment to see how well it raised awareness and fostered civic engagement. I'll gather data through surveys, feedback forms posted on the curated website, and audience interactions to measure the film's reach and influence. Compiling a report will help find if the project goals were fully met. I'll explore opportunities for ongoing engagement through digital tools and resources that can continue to educate and inspire action beyond the initial release. To sustain this project in the future, I will present the film to middle schools and high schools with connections from being on my student advisory council at school.

Resource Allocation

1. Pre-Production: \$100

Permissions and Licenses: \$100

- Fees for any necessary permission to have access to archival footage and images

2. Production: \$2,650

Video Crew: \$1200

- Includes all film with B-roll, along with all video editing and audio editing.

Interviewee Compensation: \$450

- Each interviewer will receive at least \$150. This includes compensation for researchers and community members participating in the documentary.

Producer Fee: \$1000

- Oversees full production of the project.
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5. Contingency: \$250

- Miscellaneous Expenses: \$250
- Additional in case of any need to increase the budget

Summary

- Pre-Production: \$100
- Production: \$2,650
- Contingency: 250

Total Budget: \$3,000

Monitoring and Evaluation: Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Monitoring Tools and Methods

Project Management Software: I will use project management tools such as Trello or Asana to track tasks and milestones. These tools will help manage deadlines, responsibilities, and overall workflow. I will provide brief weekly updates to the project team, summarizing progress on production milestones, quality metrics, and outreach efforts. These updates will keep the team informed and facilitate timely decision-making.

I will follow the project timeline to keep on schedule and ensure that my goals are being met in a timely manner. This would include me monitoring the progress of each act by securing locations, scheduling interviews and

having all research and scripts completed. Further, I will oversee the editing process, ensuring that rough cuts, revisions, and the final edit are completed on time and include all necessary footage and elements.

Quality and Content Metrics:

Before filming, I will ask people with knowledge of Africville's history to review the content to be sure that I have included valuable and educational information. Additionally, I will present my project overview to community members to make sure they feel that there is great representation of history and calls to action through the film.

Audience Reach and Engagement: Through the website that will display the short film, I can track engagement through the number of times the website is visited. Further, by tracking views, likes and comments on this video, I can create a report that measures the impact of the film by various demographics. I will use web and social media analytics tools (e.g., Google Analytics, Facebook Insights) to monitor viewership statistics, audience engagement, and demographic information. These insights will help evaluate the documentary's reception online.

Educational Impact: Through surveys, I can collect feedback on what the public audience thinks about the short film to see if they feel like this sheds light on the history of a vibrant African Nova Scotian Community and if it is reaching people who were previously unfamiliar with Africville.

Project Timeline:

Phase	Activity	Start Date	End Date
Research and Planning	Complete Literature Review: Gathering information about Africville's history, specifying the effects of its demolition on the community which lived there considering social, economical, cultural and educational factors.	September 20, 2024	October 10, 2024
	Identify Interviewees: For a vast array of perspectives, the story of Africville will be told by 3 individuals including one with lived experience, a descendant of a resident from the community and a researcher who is very knowledgeable about the community.	October 1, 2024	October 14, 2024
	Developing Scripts: A script will be developed for Act 1 which covers storytelling. Additionally, I will create a number of questions for the interviewees which will allow diverse perspectives to be shared. To make the filming process go as smooth as possible, the questions for Act 2 & 3 will be given to the interviewees weeks prior.	October 21, 2024	November 12, 2024
Pre Production	Logistics and Equipment: Ensure that equipment needed is available. Also securing a filming location, and any other resources needed for production.	November 6, 2024	November 15, 2024
Production	Interviews: Interviews for Act 2 & 3 will be filmed.	November 16, 2024	November 2024
	B-roll: For Act 1 and B-roll of Act 2&3, the film crew and myself will get shots from the historic community to depict the contrast of it now compared to the once thriving community. A key place that will be filmed in the Africville museum which holds archives, and gives a descriptive timeline of the events of the demolition of the community.	December 1, 2024	December 10, 2024
Post-	Editing: The video editor will add the finishing touches to the	December	December

Production	short film. The editor and I will also discuss how I want the film to be crafted and the tone that I want it to set, so that the visuals are a embodiment of the crucial storyline.	11, 2024	22, 2024
	Review and Feedback: To identify areas of improvement, the film will be shared with everyone involved in its creation along with my family and others. With this feedback, I can improve the editing of the film.	January 3, 2025	January 5, 2025
	Final Revisions: Make final adjustments and edits based on feedback.	January 6, 2025	-
	Submission: Have a finished result a few weeks prior submission deadline to ensure enough time in case of any other edits or revisions that need to be made (considering winter weather may effect filming dates).	January 7, 2025	

Conclusions:

The purpose of "Africville: A community Displaced" is to profoundly impact Nova Scotians and Canadians by bringing to light the untold stories of Africville. By presenting its history and the effects of its demolition, this documentary seeks to foster a deeper awareness and engagement with this vital part of Canadian heritage. The film aims to educate and inspire, encouraging viewers to reflect on the past and its relevance to ongoing conversations about justice and inclusion. Through this project, we hope to ensure that Africville's legacy endures and continues to influence our understanding of history and social equity.

Act 1: The Foundation of Africville (0:00 - 3:00)

- 0:00 - 0:30: The opening shot provides a brief overview of Africville's location, early settlers, and its importance as a historic Black community. Using old photos and visual cues, this segment sets the stage.

- 0:30 - 1:15: This section covers the early settlement period, highlighting why people chose Africville as their home. Maps, landscapes, and early photos will be used to highlight the formation of homes and community structures, emphasizing the resourcefulness and determination of Africville's founders.

- 1:15 - 2:00: Focus shifts to the strength of the Africville community, including key cultural and social aspects like strong leadership, mutual support, and resilience. Visuals such as churches, social events, and community gatherings illustrate the unity that defined life in Africville.

- 2:00 - 3:00: Introduce the theme of government displacement, preparing viewers for the struggles to come. Archival documents and early signs of conflict provide subtle foreshadowing of the larger impact on the Africville community.

Act 2: Historical Perspective (3:00 - 6:30)

The documentary's second act features a historian who provides deeper insights into Africville's history. The historian's account is paired with B-roll and archival images to support and visually enrich their narrative.

- 3:00 - 4:15: The historian begins by contextualizing Africville's development and early resilience. Close-up footage of the historian is interspersed with archival photos and B-roll footage, grounding the viewer in Africville's historical landscape.

- 4:15 - 5:15: This segment focuses on Africville's accomplishments and unique community achievements despite facing limited resources. The historian recounts moments that exemplify the strength of Africville's residents, including the establishment of social structures and support networks.

- 5:15 - 6:30: The historian elaborates on the government's increasing interference and eventual displacement of Africville's residents. Visuals of official documents, demolition footage, and poignant images capture the weight and consequences of the forced displacement, emphasizing the sense of loss felt by the community.

Act 3: Personal Perspectives (6:30 - 10:00)

The final act features interviews with two community members—one older and one younger—sharing their personal stories and perspectives on Africville's legacy.

- 6:30 - 7:30: Begin with introductions to each interviewee: an older individual who experienced Africville firsthand and a younger person who learned about it through family or community stories. Each brings a unique perspective that enriches the narrative.

- 7:30 - 8:15: Both interviewees answer shared questions, such as what Africville represents to them. The segment alternates between their responses, showing how Africville's story has resonated across generations.

- 8:15 - 9:00: Ask age-specific questions to each interviewee. The older participant might recall daily life in Africville, while the younger one reflects on the impact of Africville's story in their life. These responses highlight both personal memories and the broader influence of Africville's legacy.

- 9:00 - 10:00: Conclude with a few closing questions on how Africville's story should be remembered. The interviewees' final reflections provide an emotional and thoughtful ending to the documentary, reinforcing the importance of preserving and honoring Africville's legacy.